How to Use Your Website Template

A simple guide for non-technical users. Your website is built with Astro and hosted for free on GitHub Pages.

Contents

- 1. What you need
- 2. Copy the template to your computer
- 3. Install the tools (one time only)
- 4. Run the website on your computer
- 5. Create a new blog post
- 6. Edit a post
- 7. Publish or update the live website
- 8. Common problems

1. What you need

- A computer (Windows / Mac / Linux)
- Internet connection
- A free GitHub account (github.com)
- Node.js (version 18 or newer) — download from nodejs.org
- Git — download from git-scm.com

2. Copy the template to your computer

Open a terminal (PowerShell on Windows) and run:

```
git clone https://github.com/rk-shuvo209/rk-shuvo209.github.io.git my-website
cd my-website
```

This downloads all the website files into a folder called `my-website`.

> If you do not use Git, you can click "Code → Download ZIP" on the GitHub page, unzip it, and open the folder.

3. Install the tools (one time only)

Inside the project folder, run:

```
npm install
```

This downloads everything the website needs. It may take a minute. You only do this once.

4. Run the website on your computer

```
npm run dev
```

Then open your browser and go to `http://localhost:4321`. You will see your website. Changes you make to files show up automatically.

To stop the server, press `Ctrl + C` in the terminal.

To preview the final built version (exactly like the live site):

```
npm run build
npm run preview
```

5. Create a new blog post

The easiest way is the helper script. In the terminal run:

```
.\new-post.ps1 -Title "My New Post" -Excerpt "Short summary here" -Tag "SEO"
```

This creates a new file at `src/content/posts/my-new-post.md`. Open that file in any text editor and write your post using Markdown.

> **Manual method:** create a new `.md` file inside `src/content/posts/` with this at the top:

```
---
title: My New Post
date: March 2025
pubDate: 2025-03-01
excerpt: Short summary here
tag: SEO
gradient: linear-gradient(140deg, #0e1a18 0%, #0c0c0a 100%)
---
```

```
Write your post content here in Markdown.
```

Markdown basics:

- `# Heading` for big titles, `##` for smaller ones
- `**bold**` for bold text
- `*italic*` for italic text
- `- item` for bullet lists
- `1. item` for numbered lists

6. Edit a post

Open the file in `src/content/posts/`, change the text, save. If `npm run dev` is running, the page updates automatically.

7. Publish or update the live website

Your live site is on GitHub Pages and updates automatically when you push changes. Run these three commands:

```
git add .
git commit -m "Add new post"
git push
```

> **What happens next:** GitHub Actions builds your site and publishes it. This takes about 1–2 minutes. Watch progress at your repository → "Actions" tab.

After it finishes, visit `https://your-username.github.io` to see the update.

> The first time, enable GitHub Pages: Repository → Settings → Pages → Source = "GitHub Actions".

8. Common problems

- **"npm not found"** — install Node.js from nodejs.org and restart the terminal.
- **"git not found"** — install Git from git-scm.com.
- **Post does not appear** — check the file is in `src/content/posts/` and the front matter (the `---` block) is valid.
- **Build fails** — read the error message; usually a missing comma or quote in the front matter.
- **Images not showing** — put images in the `public/` folder and reference them as `/image.png`.

Generated for your Astro portfolio template.